Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 4
♥ A K J 9 8
♦ 8 7 2
♣ 8 6 5

♠ K Q 10 2
♥ 6 5
♦ A 10 9 6
♣ Q J 9

♠ J 8 6 3
♥ 10 4
♦ K Q J
♣ 10 7 3 2

♠ 9 7 5
♥ Q 7 3 2
♦ 5 4 3
♣ A K 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	2♥
All Pass			

2♥ by North
Lead: ♦K

You dealt the hand.

With 13 points and a nice 5-card Major suit you open 1♥. Partner responds 2♥. What do you say next?

You say pass. You have a minimum opening hand and partner has 6-10 points so no game is available.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 6 3
♥ Q 7 5 2
♦ K 4
♣ K 8 7 4

♠ Q J 8 5
♥ J 4
♦ Q 9 6 3
♣ 10 6 2

♠ K 10 7 2
♥ 6 3
♦ J 10 8 5
♣ A 9 3

♠ A 4
♥ A K 10 9 8
♦ A 7 2
♣ Q J 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♠Q

You dealt this hand.

Nice hand. 19 points and a good 5-card Major. You open 1♥. Partner responds 2♥. What is your next bid?

You revalue to 20 points (doubleton ♠) and partner has between 6 and 10. So, 26 to 30 is the total. Game should be there, but slam is out of reach. So you bid 4♥.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ K Q J 10 6
♥ A
♦ 9 8 7 2
♣ K J 5

♠ 5 4
♥ Q J 6 5
♦ 6 4 3
♣ 10 9 7 3

♠ A 3
♥ 10 9 7 4 2
♦ K 10 5
♣ A 8 2

♠ 9 8 7 2
♥ K 8 3
♦ A Q J
♣ Q 6 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♥10

You dealt this hand.

With 15 points and a 5-card Major you open 1♠. Partner responds 3♠.

Your 15 points gets revalued to 16/17 for the singleton. Add partner's 10-12 and you have enough for game. So you bid 4♠.

Board 4
East Deals
None Vul

♠ K 7 4 2
♥ Q 8
♦ A 6 5 3
♣ K 9 4

♠ Q 9
♥ A 10 9 7 2
♦ K 10 9
♣ 8 5 3

♠ J 10
♥ K 6 5 3
♦ Q 8 4
♣ J 10 7 2

♠ A 8 6 5 3
♥ J 4
♦ J 7 2
♣ A Q 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		Pass	1♠
Pass	3♠		
All Pass			

3♠ by South
Lead: ♣3

You dealt this hand.

With 13 points you open 1♠. Partner responds 3♠.

Figure partner for 11-12 points. You have 13 but could revalue to 14 with the doubleton ♥. But the truth is that your points are not very good ones. You should pass.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 9 5 2
♥ K J 10 8 6 4
♦ K 7 2
♣ A

♠ K J 8
♥ Q 5
♦ A 9 8 4
♣ K 10 6 2

♠ Q 10 6 4
♥ 9 2
♦ J 10 6 3
♣ 9 8 7

♠ A 7 3
♥ A 7 3
♦ Q 5
♣ Q J 5 4 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♦J

You dealt this hand.

You open 1♥ and partner responds 2♣, showing at least 11 points. You dealt this hand.

Partner's bid forces you to bid again. You have a bare-minimum hand, but at least you have a 6-card suit which you can rebid. You say 2♥ and partner raises to 4♥.

Board 6
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A K 6 5 ♥ J 9 8 6 4 ♦ 7 2 ♣ A 3	
♠ 10 9 3 ♥ 10 ♦ Q J 8 6 3 ♣ K 9 8 7		♠ Q 2 ♥ A K Q 3 2 ♦ A 10 9 ♣ 10 6 4
	♠ J 8 7 4 ♥ 7 5 ♦ K 5 4 ♣ Q J 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			

2♠ by South
Lead: ♥10

You dealt this hand.

You open 1♥ and partner responds 1♠. It is your bid again.

You have good ♠ support but you must tell partner of your minimum hand. So you bid 2♠ and he passes.

Board 7
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 9 7 3 ♥ 5 ♦ K Q 6 4 ♣ Q 8 7 6	
♠ J 2 ♥ 10 7 3 2 ♦ 9 5 3 ♣ K 10 9 5	N W E S	♠ Q 8 4 ♥ Q J 9 ♦ A J 10 8 ♣ J 4 2
	♠ A 10 6 5 ♥ A K 8 6 4 ♦ 7 2 ♣ A 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♣2

You dealt this hand.

Naturally you open 1♥. Partner responds 1♠. What do you say next?

Partner has at least 4 ♠s and you have 4. So you have found the 8-card Major fit. Now it is a question of finding the right level. Your job is to further describe your hand as either minimum, medium, or maximum. With 17/18 points (revalued) you are a medium, so you jump to 3♠.

Partner bids the game.

Board 8
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 9 7 3
♥ A 10 9 5
♦ Q J 3
♣ 10

♠ J 10 5 2
♥ K 8 3 2
♦ 2
♣ A 7 4 3

♠ 8 6
♥ J 6 4
♦ A 8 6 5 4
♣ 9 5 2

♠ A 4
♥ Q 7
♦ K 10 9 7
♣ K Q J 8 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♦2

You dealt this hand.

Of course you open 1♠. Partner responds 2♣. What is your next bid?

Partner has shown at least 11 points and you are forced to bid again. Since the ♥s rank below ♠s you can bid them with your minimum hand. Apparently that is just what partner wanted to hear since he jumps to 3NT which you happily pass.

Board 9
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 6 2
♥ K 9 7 3
♦ A 8 4
♣ A 9 8 3

♠ Q J 10 8
♥ A 8 6
♦ 9 7 3
♣ J 6 5

♠ K 4
♥ 4 2
♦ 10 6 5 2
♣ K Q 10 4 2

♠ A 9 7 5 3
♥ Q J 10 5
♦ K Q J
♣ 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♣K

You dealt this hand.

You open 1♠ and partner responds 2♥.

Partner has shown 11+ points and at least 4 ♥s. Your hand revalues to 16 points in support of ♥s, where you know you have an 8-card fit or better. You bid 4♥ confidently.

Board 10
South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 6
♥ K 8 7 3
♦ A 9 7
♣ 10 8 5 4

♠ J 9
♥ 10 9 4
♦ J 8 3
♣ A Q 9 6 3

♠ 8 4 2
♥ A 6 2
♦ 6 5 4 2
♣ K J 2

♠ A K 10 7 5 3
♥ Q J 5
♦ K Q 10
♣ 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♥10

You dealt this hand.

We all know you will open 1♠ with this hand. And after partner responds 1NT what is your next bid?

With 6 of them you can rebid ♠s but you are too strong to say just 2♠. Your 17 points puts you in the Medium range where you make a jump. So you bid 3♠ and partner bids 4♠.

Board 11
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 6
♥ A Q J 9 8
♦ A K 8 5
♣ K Q J

♠ Q J 9 8 3
♥ 10 4
♦ Q J 10 9
♣ 6 4

♠ K 7 5 4
♥ 6 3
♦ 6 2
♣ 10 8 5 3 2

♠ A 10 2
♥ K 7 5 2
♦ 7 4 3
♣ A 9 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by North
Lead: ♦6

You dealt this hand.

This is a big hand. But not quite enough to open 2♣. So you open 1♥ and partner responds 3♥. Now what?

You might bid 4♦ as a slam try, but it is probably just as well to go ahead and ask for Aces. So you bid 4NT and partner owns up to holding 2 Aces. What is your next bid?

You have all the Aces but don't go crazy. Partner only has 11-12 points so don't think too Grand! Bid 6♥.

Board 12
South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 9 8 7
♥ 10 8 6
♦ A Q 8 5
♣ 6 3 2

♠ J 10 6 3 2
♥ 9 3
♦ 10 4 2
♣ Q J 4

♠ A Q 4
♥ J 4 2
♦ J 9 7
♣ K 9 7 5

♠ K 5
♥ A K Q 7 5
♦ K 6 3
♣ A 10 8

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♣Q

The bidding has been as shown.

With 6 points you must respond and you should let partner know you have support for his suit. So you bid 2♥ and he promptly raises to 4♥. It's a good thing he had 20 points isn't it.

Board 13
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 7 4 2
♥ K 10 7 4 2
♦ A Q 4
♣ K 3

♠ K Q J 10 9
♥ A
♦ 9 7 3
♣ Q J 5 2

♠ A 6 5 3
♥ J 6
♦ 10 6 2
♣ A 10 9 7

♠ 8
♥ Q 9 8 5 3
♦ K J 8 5
♣ 8 6 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♦2

The bidding has been as shown.

When you have a weak, distributional hand with 5 of partner's suit an immediate jump to game is usually the best approach. If he has a good hand you will probably make the contract. If he is minimum then you might get a preemptive effect and stop your LHO from entering the bidding.

This is a good example. Partner may be lucky and make 4♥. But if they had had an opportunity to compete the opponents might well be able to make 4♠.

Board 14
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 9 7 2
♥ Q 5
♦ 7 4 2
♣ 10 6 5

♠ Q 8 5 4
♥ 6 4
♦ 10 8 6
♣ K J 8 2

♠ J 10 6
♥ 10 9 2
♦ K 9 5
♣ A Q 9 4

♠ 3
♥ A K J 8 7 3
♦ A Q J 3
♣ 7 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♥4

The bidding has been as shown.

You can't support partner's ♥s with only 2 of them so you bid your nice ♠ suit. Partner then jumps to 3♥. Now

Here's where a lot of players go wrong. Since they only promised 4 ♠s with their first response they think they should now rebid them to show partner they had 5. And this **MIGHT** work if it turns out partner has 3 ♠s. Not only is this a risky bid, it is unnecessary. When partner jump rebid ♥s he showed 16-18 points and 6 ♥s. So you know of an 8-card fit and you know you should be in game. Bid 4♥.

Board 15
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A Q 10 9 3 ♥ A 9 2 ♦ K Q J 3 ♣ 4	
♠ 8 4 ♥ K 7 4 3 ♦ A 10 8 5 ♣ 10 7 2		♠ 6 5 ♥ Q J 10 6 ♦ 9 6 ♣ J 9 8 6 3
	♠ K J 7 2 ♥ 8 5 ♦ 7 4 2 ♣ A K Q 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	4♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♠ by North
Lead: ♥Q

The bidding has been as shown.

As soon as partner opens 1♠ you know you will settle for nothing less than the ♠ game. The problem with bidding 4♠ right now is that partner will take you for the "weak-distributional-with-five-trumps" hand. So you temporize by first bidding 2♣. Partner rebids 2♦.

You now jump to 4♠, completing the picture of an opening hand with good ♠ support. Partner bids 4NT. What say you?

This is Blackwood so you answer 5♦ for one Ace. Partner says 6♠.

Board 16
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A K 10 8 ♥ 9 8 5 3 ♦ Q 10 9 6 ♣ 8	
♠ J 4 3 2 ♥ Q ♦ 7 4 2 ♣ 9 6 5 4 2		♠ Q 9 6 ♥ J 2 ♦ A 8 5 3 ♣ A K 7 3
	♠ 7 5 ♥ A K 10 7 6 4 ♦ K J ♣ Q J 10	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♠3

The bidding has been as shown.

You could bid 1♠. Many would do so, thinking "I have to show partner my ♠ suit."

In fact, you don't have to show partner your ♠ suit. You already know of a partnership 9-card fit in ♥s, so there is no reason to search for a possible 8-card fit in ♠s.

With 11 points and 4 trumps you bid 3♥, a limit raise. Partner raises to game.

Board 17
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 10 8
♥ Q 6
♦ Q J 9 6
♣ A 9 6

♠ 7 5
♥ 10 9 3 2
♦ 4 3 2
♣ Q J 10 8

♠ J 4 3
♥ 8 5
♦ A K 8 7
♣ K 5 4 2

♠ A 9 6 2
♥ A K J 7 4
♦ 10 5
♣ 7 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♦K

The bidding has been as shown.

You **MIGHT** jump to 2NT to "show your points". However, a notrump bid now would deny a 4-card ♠ suit. Instead, your priority is to show that Major, so you respond 1♠. Partner bids 2♠. What do you say next?

Partner would not support a response which might be 4 cards unless he had 4 himself. Knowing that you have two opening hands facing each other, each containing 4 ♠s, you bid the ♠ game.

Board 18
South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K Q 8 6
♥ J 7 6
♦ Q J 7 6
♣ 9 6

♠ J 3 2
♥ 10 8 3
♦ 4 3
♣ K Q 10 5 2

♠ 4
♥ A 9 5 4 2
♦ A 9 8 2
♣ 8 4 3

♠ A 10 9 7 5
♥ K Q
♦ K 10 5
♣ A J 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣K

The bidding has been as shown.

With 4-card support you respond 2♠. Partner raises to 3♠. What do you say next?

Partner's bid is an invitation. You have told him you have 6-10 points and he probably has about 17-18. If you are at the high end of your 6-10 he wants you to bid game, at the low end he wants you to pass. You actually have 10, definitely high end, so you bid 4♠.

Board 19
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 10 9 7 5
♥ K Q
♦ A 3
♣ Q 10 4 3

♠ 4 3 2
♥ 8 4 3
♦ 8 5 4 2
♣ A K J

♠ J
♥ A 10 9 5 2
♦ K Q 10 9
♣ 8 7 2

♠ K Q 8 6
♥ J 7 6
♦ J 7 6
♣ 9 6 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♠
All Pass			

3♠ by North
Lead: ♦K

The bidding has been as shown.

With 7 points and good trumps you respond 2♠. Partner now bids 3♣.

Again partner is inviting you to bid game. He wants you to bid it if you are at the top of your 6-10 range, and he wants you to particularly promote any Help you can give him in ♣s.

You are at the bottom of your range and you have no help in ♣s, so you just return to ♠s. Partner passes.

Board 20
South Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 9 3 ♥ Q 10 6 ♦ K Q 10 3 ♣ 9 6 5 4	
♠ Q 8 ♥ 9 8 2 ♦ A 9 4 ♣ Q J 7 3 2	N W E S	♠ J 10 7 6 5 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 8 6 5 ♣ A K 8
	♠ A K 4 2 ♥ A K J 5 3 ♦ J 7 2 ♣ 10	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♠Q

The bidding has been as shown.

Your only reasonable response is 2♥. Partner now bids 3♦.

With 8 points you are right in the middle of the 6-10 points you promised. So you could either accept partner's invitation or decline it. BUT, he said you should particularly look at any Help you could provide in ♦s. Since you have lots of good stuff in that suit you upgrade your 8 points and bid 4♥.